

RUN-001 - Password Reset & Account Unlock (Okta)

Purpose

Provide L1 Service Desk staff with step-by-step procedures to reset a user's Okta password and/or unlock a locked Okta account. This covers standard user accounts; privileged/admin account unlocks require L2 approval (see Escalation).

Prerequisites / Access Needed

Requirement	Details
Okta Admin Console access	Role: Help Desk Administrator - request via REQ in SummitDesk if not provisioned
Identity verification	Must confirm caller identity before taking action (see Step 1)
SummitDesk ticket	Every action must be logged against an INC or REQ ticket
MFA	Your own Okta Verify push must be active to access the Admin Console

Procedure

1. Verify Caller Identity

Before any account action, confirm the user's identity using **two** of the following:

- Employee ID (format: SUM-#####)
- Manager's full name
- Last four digits of their work phone on file
- Date of birth (for employees - not contractors)
- Recent ticket number they opened

If the caller cannot provide two factors, do **not** proceed. Log the attempt in the ticket and advise the user to appear in person at their nearest IT office with a government-issued ID, or have their manager submit a request on their behalf via <https://help.summitit.com>.

2. Open a Ticket

1. Log into SummitDesk at <https://help.summitit.com>.
2. Create or open the existing INC/REQ ticket for this user.
3. Note the ticket ID (e.g., INC-004812) - you will reference it in your Okta audit note.

3. Access Okta Admin Console

1. Navigate to <https://summitit.okta.com/admin>.
2. Authenticate with your IT staff credentials and approve the Okta Verify push.
3. Go to **Directory > People**.

4. Locate the User

1. Search by first name, last name, or UPN (`firstname.lastname@summitit.com`).
2. Confirm the result matches the correct employee - check Department and Manager fields.
3. Click the user's name to open their profile.

5a. Unlock a Locked Account

1. On the user's profile page, check the **Status** badge. It will read **Locked Out** if the account is locked.
2. Click **Unlock** (top-right action menu or the inline **Unlock** button).
3. Okta will immediately set the status back to **Active**.
4. In the **More Actions** dropdown, select **Add Note** and enter: `Unlocked per [ticket ID]. Identity verified by [your name]`.

5b. Reset Password (Admin-Initiated Temp Password)

Use this when the user has forgotten their password or when instructed by a manager/HR.

1. On the user's profile, click **More Actions > Reset Password**.
2. Select **Send user an email with a link to reset their password** (preferred - sends to their secondary/personal email on file). - If no secondary email is on file, select **Set a temporary password** and read it to the verified user over the phone, or relay via a secure channel (1Password - share a one-time secret).
3. Confirm the action. The user's status changes to **Password Reset**.
4. Inform the user the link expires in **60 minutes**.
5. Add an Okta note: `Password reset per [ticket ID]. Identity verified by [your name]`.

5c. Reset Password AND Unlock (Both Needed)

If the account is both locked and the password must be reset:

1. Perform **5a** (Unlock) first.
2. Then perform **5b** (Reset Password).

6. MFA Factor Re-enrollment (If Required)

If the user has lost access to their Okta Verify device and cannot self-serve:

1. On the user profile, go to the **Security** tab.

2. Under **Enrolled Factors**, locate **Okta Verify**.
3. Click the gear icon > **Remove** to unenroll the factor.
4. Instruct the user to re-enroll at <https://summitit.okta.com/user/settings> by clicking **Set up** next to Okta Verify.
5. Log the factor removal in the ticket: `Okta Verify factor removed for re-enrollment per [ticket ID]`.

YubiKey factor removal for privileged accounts requires L2 authorization. Do not remove YubiKey factors without L2 sign-off.

7. Notify the User

- Confirm with the user that they can log in at <https://summitit.okta.com>.
- Remind them that their new password must meet Summit IT password policy:
- Minimum 14 characters
- At least one uppercase, one lowercase, one number, one special character
- Cannot reuse the last 10 passwords
- Remind them to update their password in 1Password.

8. Close the Ticket

1. Update the ticket with actions taken and resolution.
2. Set ticket status to **Resolved**.
3. Category: Identity & Access / Sub-category: Password / Account Unlock.

Verification

Check	Expected Result
Okta user status	Active
User can log in at summitit.okta.com	Successful authentication
MFA prompt received and approved	Okta Verify push delivered and approved
Ticket notes	Audit note present in Okta profile

Rollback / If It Fails

Symptom	Action
Unlock button greyed out or missing	Account may be suspended (not locked) - escalate to L2

Password reset email not received	Check secondary email address on Okta profile; resend; check spam; verify email is correct
Temp password rejected at login	Confirm account status is Active , not Password Reset expired ; re-issue temp password
User still cannot log in after reset	Check for Okta sign-on policy restrictions or network/IP block - escalate to L2
"You do not have permission" error in Okta console	Your Help Desk Admin role may not be provisioned; escalate to L2

Escalation

Condition	Escalate To	Contact
Privileged / admin account locked	L2 - Identity & Access team	identity@summitit.com / Teams: @I2-identity
Suspected unauthorized access or account compromise	L3 / SOC immediately	soc@summitit.com / +1 (800) 555-7866 x3 (24/7)
Cannot locate user in Okta	L2	identity@summitit.com
YubiKey factor removal needed	L2	identity@summitit.com
Mass account lockout (>5 users simultaneously)	P1 - escalate to L3 + notify SOC	Major Incident process: RUN-007